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DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N.R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump said his talks with Chinese President Xi Jinping could promote “peace and prosperity for decades” as the leaders of the world’s two biggest economies pledged cooperation at the start of a closely watched White House summit yesterday.

Welcoming Xi for a lavish state visit, Trump said the two countries had made “tremendous strides” by working together and would discuss security, technology and artificial intelligence.

“The decisions we make in these areas today can promote peace and prosperity for decades and decades to come,” Trump said.

Xi struck a similarly conciliatory tone, saying China and the United States should strengthen communication, manage their differences and avoid confrontation.

Coexist despite differences

“We must hold the line of no conflict and no confrontation,” Xi said, adding that the two powers could find a way to coexist despite their differences.

The 80-year-old US president hailed what he called his “truly great friendship” with the Chinese leader, with whom he has met three times since returning to power last year.

“Working together, President Xi and I have made tremendous strides on the issues facing our two countries,” Trump said.

Behind the warm words, however, the two leaders face a difficult agenda ranging from the war in Iran and Taiwan to trade and advanced technology.

Trump confirmed ahead of the summit that Iran would be discussed. Washington wants Beijing to use its considerable influence with Tehran as the United States seeks an end to the nearly

TRUMP: XI TALKS CAN BRING PEACE AND PROSPERITY FOR DECADES

Two powers must avoid conflict and confrontation, Xi says



AP

■ US President Donald Trump and first lady Melania Trump greet China's President Xi Jinping and his wife Peng Liyuan on the South Portico of the White House yesterday.

seven-month conflict. China has so far resisted US pressure — including economic threats — to push Iran to accept Washington's terms for ending the war.

Beijing's economic and diplomatic support for Tehran has become one of the points of friction between Washington and China. Trump had earlier played down reports that Beijing was providing intelligence to Iran but said he would discuss the issue with Xi.

Taiwan is another major issue. Xi wants Washington to halt

arms sales to the self-governing island, which Beijing claims as its territory, while the United States has also imposed restrictions on exports of cutting-edge technology to China.

Trade a flashpoint

Trade remains another potential flashpoint, although the two sides moved to ease immediate tensions ahead of the summit. US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent announced on Wednesday that a trade truce due to expire in November had been extended

for two months. Artificial intelligence also featured prominently in the opening exchanges. Xi said both countries had a responsibility to ensure AI remained “under human control” and served people's well-being.

Trump, meanwhile, repeatedly emphasised his personal relationship with Xi, describing it as a “truly great friendship” as the two leaders began a summit carrying consequences well beyond Washington and Beijing.

— With AP and AFP inputs

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US BAN FALLOUT

Iranian airlines' flights to and from the UAE suspended

ABU DHABI

The General Civil Aviation Authority (GCAA) announced the suspension of flights operated by Iranian airlines to and from the UAE, effective from yesterday, until further notice.

The GCAA confirmed that the decision was made in light of the US ban imposed on Iranian airlines from using airports in various countries around the world.

Keeping informed

The GCAA also stated that it will continue to keep the relevant authorities and the public informed of any developments as they arise, pending the resumption of normal air traffic between the two countries.

The General Civil Aviation Authority urged the public to obtain information exclusively from official and authorised sources.

— WAM

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FRIDAY

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NBA legend Thompson seeks to build Dubai's basketball legacy

Dubai Basketball's Global Ambassador wants ABA League champs to rule Europe

DUBAI

BY ROBERT ILSLEY
Sports Reporter

NBA champion Tristan Thompson is taking on a new challenge in Dubai, joining Dubai Basketball as the club's Global Ambassador after 15 years at the highest level of the sport.

The former Cleveland Cavaliers star, who shared a locker room with LeBron James and was part of the team that produced one of the greatest comebacks in NBA history in 2016, believes Dubai Basket-



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

■ Tristan Thompson

ball have the potential to have a similar impact on the UAE that the Toronto Raptors had on basketball in Canada.

In an exclusive interview with Gulf News, Thompson explains why he was attracted to the rapidly growing franchise and reveals his excitement at helping build a basketball culture in a city which is still developing its sporting landscape.

Dubai Basketball have already made remarkable progress since their formation in 2023, winning the ABA League title and making an impressive first step into European basketball.

Rising expectations

With a stronger squad, an elite European coach in Xavi Pascual and ambitions to compete at the highest level, expectations are now rising.

Thompson will use his experience of winning at the highest level to help guide the team, telling players they can “use me as a sponge” as they chase their own success.

And when asked where he wants Dubai Basketball to be in three years, Thompson had one simple answer: “A EuroLeague champion.”

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